

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Excel ribbon with the 'Conditional Formatting' menu open. A red box highlights the menu, and a red arrow points from it to a list of advanced Excel features. The features listed are:

- Data validation criteria and drop-down lists
- Using pivot tables to summarise large datasets
- Basic VBA programming to write macros and functions
- Using Power Pivot, Power Query and other modern data tools
- Advanced charting techniques, layouts and formatting

Continuously upgrading Excel capabilities and becoming an expert user remain key career investments for any consultant. However, the critical first step is a solid foundation with the above functions and features.